ሥርዓተ፡ጽዮን፡ ※ The Order of Zion

Introduction

The *Order of Zion* (*Sirate Tsion*) is the text also known as *the Canons of the Apostles after the Ascension*. It opens with a narrative of the Ascension and Pentecost and of the regions to which each apostle was sent, sets out thirty statutes on worship and the life of the church (which way to face in prayer, which days to keep, what is read and in what order), and closes with a second narrative. The title, *The Order of Zion*, is not used by the text itself, and Alessandro Bausi, the modern editor of the Ethiopic Sinodos, does not record it among the traditional names. The Syriac tradition divides it into 27 ordinances and the Ethiopic and Arabic into 30; where the correspondence is known, it is noted herein.

The Ge'ez text presented here is that of Allesandro Bausi, from the TEI collection[§]; the English text is closely based on Breandan Lumpkin's translation.[¶] In the footnotes, translations of the Syriac text are also based on Lumpkin's translation, in an earlier publication.

Authorship and Dates

Within the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church canon, the text is traditionally attributed to the Twelve Apostles; the prologue notes that it was compiled or recorded by Clement of Rome on their behalf. However, secular historians classify the work as a pseudo-apostolic church order, meaning it was composed by anonymous early Christian leaders who attributed the writing to the Apostles to establish authority for its liturgical and ecclesiastical regulations.

Sirate Tsion is identified by scholars as the Ge'ez version of the *Canons after the Ascension*; the broader collection of Christian pseudo-apostolic church orders from which it derives was composed primarily between the 3rd and 5th Centuries CE. The text was translated into Ge'ez and incorporated into the *Book of Sinodos* during the formal translation periods of the Ethiopian Church, likely between the 5th and 14th Centuries, with its current manuscript tradition solidifying in later mediaeval codices.

At the very end of the text, reference is made to the Greek work known as *Batlesat* (which equates to 'Didache'); however, we now know that the Didache has a considerably stronger correlation with the first section of The Book of Herald (Te'ezaz).

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§ Alessandro Bausi, Pietro Maria Liuzzo, "*Apostolic Canons after Ascension*," https://betamasaheft.eu/works/LIT2673CanonsAscension.

¶ Breandan Lumpkin, "*The Lost Books of the Ethiopian Bible*." 2026; Fifth Estate Publishing, Blountsville, AL.

PROLOGUE

ዝንቱ፡ መጽሐፍ፡ ዜናሆሙ፡ ለሐዋርያት፡ እምድኅረ፡ ዐርገ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ወአምላክነ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ዘአዘዙ፡ ሴኖዶስ፡ ዘጸሐፈ፡ ቀሌምንጦስ፡ በእንተ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ዘከመ፡ ሠርዑ፡ ለቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ቅድስት፡ እንተ፡ ተሣየጣ፡ በደሙ፡ ክቡር።

This book is the account of the Apostles after our Lord and our God Christ ascended; which the Sinodos commanded, and which Clement wrote about the Apostles, how they ordained for the holy Church, purchased with his precious blood.

ወወሀቡ፡ ለዘ፡ ተለዎሙ፡ ወቦአ፡ ውስተ፡ ጽዋዔሆሙ፡ ወአምነ፡ በእግዚአብሔር፡ በእደዊሆሙ፡ እምኵሉ፡ አሕዛብ፡ ወአይሁድኒ። ወአዘዙ፡ መትልዎሙ፡ እምድኅሬሆሙ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ እምቅድመ፡ ጉባኤ፡ ዘኒቂያ፡ ዘሠርዑ፡ ሕገ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወሞእዎሙ፡ ለዕልዋን፡ እለ፡ ይትቃረንዋ፡ ለጽድቅ፡ ወወሀቡ፡ ትእዛዘ፡ እምወንጌል፡ ወእምባዕዳን፡ መጻሕፍተ፡ እግዚአብሔር።

And they gave it to him who followed them, and who entered into their calling and believed in God by their hands, from all the gentiles and from the Jews also. And they commanded their successors after them, the bishops before the Council of Nicaea,[i] who ordained the law of God and overcame the heretics who oppose the truth; and they gave commandment out of the Gospel and out of the other books of God.

ወአርአየ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ጽድቀ፡ በኵሉ፡ መዋዕል፡ በመዊእ፡ ወበቃል፡ ገሃደ፡ ወአስተኃፈሮሙ፡ ለዕልዋን፡ በመርገም፡ ዘለዓለም፡ ወአርዳኢሁሰ፡ እምድኅረ፡ ተንሥአ፡ እምውታን፡ ሀለዉ፡ ዝርዋን፡ በምድረ፡ ገሊላ፡ ወሀገረ፡ ናዝሬት፡ ኀበ፡ አዘዞሙ። ወበአርብዓ፡ ዕለት፡ እምድኅረ፡ ትንሣኤሁ፡ ተጋብኡ፡ ኀበ፡ ደብረ፡ ዘይት፡ በኢየሩሳሌም፡ ወክርስቶስ፡ ምስሌሆሙ፡ እንዘ፡ ኢያአምርዎ፡ በማእከሌሆሙ። ወአስተርአዮሙ፡ በይእቲ፡ ዕለት፡ ወአንበረ፡ እዴሁ፡ ዲበ፡ ርእሶሙ፡ ለለ፡ አሐዱ፡ አሐዱ፡ እምኔሆሙ፡ ለዐሠርቱ፡ ወአሐዱ፡ አርዳኢሁ፡ ወባረኮሙ፡ ወረሰዮሙ፡ ካህናተ፡ ህየንተ፡ ካህናተ፡ ደቂቀ፡ እስራኤል፡ ምኑናን።

And God showed righteousness in all days, by victory and by word, manifestly; and he put the rebels to shame with an everlasting curse.[ii] And his disciples, after he rose from the dead, were scattered in the land of Galilee and the city of Nazareth, where he had commanded them. And, on the fortieth day after his resurrection, they gathered at the Mount of Olives in Jerusalem, and Christ was with them in their midst, while they did not know him. And he appeared to them on that day, and laid his hand on the head of each one of them, of his eleven disciples, and blessed them, and made them priests in place of the despised priests, the children of Israel.

PROLOGUE

[i] The mention of the '*Council of Nicaea*' (325 CE) indicates that the current text has been edited no earlier than the 4th Century.

[ii] Lumpkin's translation lacks this sentence.

እስመ፡ ከመዝ፡ ይቤ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በአፈ፡ ሚኪያስ፡ ነቢይ፡ ዘይቤ፡ አደቂቀ፡ አሮን፡ ናሁ፡ መነንኩ፡ ክህነተ፡ ሌዊ፡ አቡክሙ፡ ወኢይዜክሩ፡ እንከ፡ ክህነቶ፡ ለአሮን፡ እስመ፡ ካህን፡ መልአከ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወይቤ፡ በወንጌል፡ ናሁ፡ አነ፡ እፈኑ፡ መልአክየ፡ ቅድመ፡ ገጽከ፡ ዘይጸይሕ፡ ፍኖተከ።

For, thus said God by the mouth of Micah the prophet, who said, “O sons of Aaron, behold, I have rejected the priesthood of Levi your father, and they shall no longer remember the priesthood of Aaron; for, the priest is the messenger of God.”[iii] And he said in the Gospel, “Behold, I send my messenger before your face, who shall make your way plain.”

ወእምዝ፡ ጸሮ፡ ደመና፡ ብሩህ፡ ወአልዐሎ፡ እማእከሎሙ፡ እንዘ፡ ይሬኢይዎ፡ እስከ፡ ተላዐለ፡ እስከ፡ ሰማይ፡ እንዘ፡ ያንቀዐድዉ፡ በአዕይንቲሆሙ። ወሰገዱ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ እስመ፡ ርእይዎ፡ እንዘ፡ የዐርግ፡ ሰማየ፡ በከመ፡ ነገሮሙ፡ ወተፈሥሑ፡ ዐቢየ፡ ፍሥሓ፡ እስመ፡ አንበረ፡ እዴሁ፡ ዲቤሆሙ፡ ወሜሞሙ፡ ካህናተ፡ ወሶበ፡ ተሰወሮሙ፡ ገብኡ፡ ውስተ፡ ጽርሕ፡ ጎበ፡ በልዑ፡ ምስሌሁ፡ ፍሥሐ፡ ወነበሩ፡ ውስቴታ፡ እንዘ፡ ይጼልዩ፡ ወይጸውሙ፡ ዐሡረ፡ መዋዕለ፡ ወሐለዩ፡ ጎበ፡ የሐውሩ፡ ከመ፡ ይጸውዑ፡ ሰብአ፡ ውስተ፡ አሚን።

And then a bright cloud bore him and lifted him up from their midst while they beheld him, until he was raised up to heaven while they gazed with their eyes. And they worshipped God, because they saw him going up to heaven as he had told them; and they rejoiced with great joy, because he had laid his hand on them and appointed them priests. And, when he was hidden from them, they went to the upper room where they had eaten with him gladly, and they remained in it praying and fasting ten days; and they took thought where they should go, so that they might call men into the faith.

ወኢያአምሩ፡ ልሳናቲሆሙ፡ ወኢይሌብዉ፡ ቃሎሙ። ወይቤሎሙ፡ ጴጥሮስ፡ ዘውእቱ፡ ርእስ፡ በጎበ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ላዕለ፡ ኵሎሙ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ዘሰመዮ፡ ስምዖን፡ ጴጥሮስ፡ ኢኮነ፡ ዝንቱ፡ ግብር፡ ጎቤነ፡ አላ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ዘአሰፈወነ፡ ከመ፡ ይፈኑ፡ ለነ፡ ጰራቅሊጦስ፡ ዘውእቱ፡ መንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ ወውእቱ፡ ያሌብወነ፡ ኵሎ፡ ዘይደልወነ፡ ናስምዕ፡ ወንግበር፡ ወእንዘ፡ ይነግሮሙ፡ ጴጥሮስ፡ ዘንተ፡ ወናሁ፡ ሰምዑ፡ ድምፀ፡ ከመ፡ ድምፀ፡ ነፋስ፡ ዐውሎ፡ ወአጼነዉ፡ ጼና፡

And they did not know their tongues, nor understand their speech. And Peter said to them, he who is head, with Christ, over all the Apostles, whom he named Simon Peter, “This work is not of us but of our Lord, who promised us he would send us the Paraclete[iv], who is the Holy Spirit; and he will make us understand all that is fitting for us to testify and to do. And, while Peter was telling them this, behold, they heard a sound like the sound of a stormy wind, and they smelled a sweet

[iii] The quotation is not from the canonical *Book of Micah*; others attribute the words to Malachi.

[iv] The word, ‘*Paraclete*’, means an advocate, helper, counsellor, comforter, or intercessor.

ጥዑመ፡ ዘኢያአምሩ፡ ከማሁ፡ በውስተ፡ ዓለም። ወአስተርአየ፡ ማእከሎሙ፡ ልሳናተ፡ እሳት፡ ዘይወርድ፡ ላዕለ፡ አሐዱ፡ አሐዱ፡ እምኔሆሙ።

fragrance the like of which they had not known in the world. And there appeared in their midst tongues of fire, descending on each one of them.

ወአኀዙ፡ ይትናገሩ፡ በልሳን፡ ሐዲስ፡ ኀበ፡ የሐውሩ፡ ለጽዋዔ፡ ሰብእ፡ ውስተ፡ አሚን፡ ወለአለብዎቶሙ፡ ዘይደልዎሙ፡ ይግበሩ፡ ወከመ፡ ይምሀሩ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ጸሎተ፡ ወተቀንዮ፡ ወሕገ፡ ወሥርዐተ። ወአእኰትዎ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ በእንተ፡ ዘአለበዎሙ፡ ወጾሙ፡ አርብዓ፡ ዕለተ፡ ለአኰቴተ፡ ዚአሁ። እምዝ፡ ተዘርዉ፡ ውስተ፡ ርሑቅ፡ በሓውርት፡ ከመ፡ ይጸውዑ፡ ሰብአ፡ ውስተ፡ አሚን፡ በከመ፡ አዘዞሙ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ወኮነ፡ ሰባኬ፡ ወመጥምቀ፡ ወሠያሜ፡ ካህናት፡ ዘቀደመ፡ ክህነተ፡ ወዘአእመነ፡ ኵሎ፡ አይሁደ፡ ወሰብአ፡ እለ፡ ይነብሩ፡ ኢየሩሳሌም፡ ወበምድረ፡ ፍልስጤም፡ ወአድያሚሃ፡ ወኵሉ፡ አህጉር፡ ኀምስ፡ ወቂሳርያ፡ ወሳምር፡ ወምድረ፡ ዐረብ፡ ያዕቆብ፡ እኁሁ፡ ለእግዚእነ፡ ወውእቱ፡ ሥሉጥ፡ ላዕለ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያነ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ እንተ፡ ይእቲ፡ ጽዮን፡ ወማርቆስ፡ ወንጌላዊ፡ በእልስክንድርያ፡ ወግብጽ፡ ወኖባ፡ ወምድረ፡ ኢትዮጵያ፡ እስከ፡ ጽንፉ፡ ወህንዳኬ፡ ወስንድ፡ ወዘየዐውዳ፡ እስከ፡ ባሕረ፡ ኢርትራ፡ ቶማስ፡ ሐዋርያ፡ ወሶርያ፡ ወአንጾኪያ፡ ወገላቲያ፡ እስከ፡ ቀሬጤስ፡ ፎኖጥስ፡ ስምዖን፡ ኬፋ፡ ዘውእቱ፡ ጴጥሮስ።

And they began to speak with a new tongue, concerning where they should go for the calling of men into the faith, and for instructing them in what they ought to do, and that they might teach men prayer and service and law and ordinance. And they gave thanks to God because he had instructed them, and they fasted forty[v] days in thanksgiving to him. Then they were scattered into far regions, to call men into the faith, just as Christ had commanded them. And the preacher and baptizer and appointer of priests, first in the priesthood and who brought to the faith all the Jews and the people who dwell in Jerusalem and in the land of Palestine and its districts, and all the five cities, and Caesarea, and Samaria, and the land of Arabia, was James the brother of our Lord; and he has authority over the church of the Apostles, which is Zion. And Mark the evangelist in Alexandria, Egypt, Nubia, and the land of Ethiopia as far as its border. And India, Sind[vi], and what lies around it, as far as the Erythraean Sea – Thomas the Apostle. And Syria, and Antioch, and Galatia, as far as Crete, and Pontus – Simon Cephas, who is Peter.

ወእንዘ፡ ይትለአክ፡ በጽሐ፡ ኀቤሁ፡ ዜና፡ ሴሞን፡ መሠርይ፡ እንዘ፡ ሀሎ፡ በሀገረ፡ ሮሜ፡ ወአስሐቶሙ፡ ለሰብኣ፡

And, while he was ministering, news reached him of Simon the sorcerer, who was in the city of Rome and had deceived its

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[v] In the Ge'ez text, '*forty*' is here spelled out in full (**አርብዓ**) rather than being given as a numeral (፵).

[vi] '*Sind*' is the region now known as Pakistan.

በሥራዩ፡ ወበዕልወቱ። ወሖረ፡ ኀቤሃ፡ ወአምኑ፡ ኵሎሙ፡ ሰብኣ፡ በእዴሁ፡ ወአጥመቆሙ፡ ለኵሎሙ፡ ወዓዲ፡ ሰብአ፡ አንጾኪያ፡ ወአስጳንያ፡ ወዘየዐውዶሙ፡ አህጉር፡ ወኵሎ፡ ሮሜ።

ወአጥፍኦ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ለሲሞን፡ መሠርይ፡ በስእለቱ፡ ወጸሎቱ፡ ለቅዱስ፡ ወአስተርአየ፡ ሀይማኖት፡ ውስተ፡ ኵላ፡ ይእቲ፡ ምድር፡ በቅድስናሁ፡ ወንጽሑ፡ ወትዕግሥቱ፡ ወዮሐንስ፡ ወንጌላዊ፡ በኤፌሶን፡ ወተሰሎንቄ፡ ወአስያ፡ ወጢሮስ፡ ወአካይያ፡ ወኵሎ፡ ምድረ፡ ፊሪቅያ፡ እንድርያስ፡ እኁሁ፡ ለስምዖን፡ በኒቂያ፡ ወበኒቂድያ፡ ወኵሎ፡ ምድረ፡ ዲኑንያ፡ ወአድያሚሃ፡ እምወሰና፡ ሉቃስ፡ ጸሓፌ፡ ወንጌል፡ በዘንጢያ፡ ወበርቂያ፡ ወፍርቂያ፡ ወዘየዐውዳ፡ እስከ፡ አድያመ፡ ምዕራብ፡ እስከ፡ ባሕር፡ ዘየዐቢ፡ ወመርማሪ፡ ዘእምሰብዓ፡ አርድእት፡ በደሴት፡ ወፋርስ፡ ወምድረ፡ ባቢሎን፡ ወኵሎሙ፡ ጸለምት፡ ወዘየዐውዶሙ፡ ወምድረ፡ ቴማን፡ ወደሰያት፡ ወምድረ፡ ዐረብ፡ እለ፡ ይነብሩ፡ በሐይመታት፡ እስከ፡ ባሕረ፡ የም፡ ወአካይ፡ ረድኡ፡ ለመርማሪ፡ በምድረ፡ አድባር፡ ወአሕዋዝ፡ ወተርሴስ፡ እስከ፡ ምድረ፡ ስንድ፡ ወእስከ፡ ጎግ፡ ወማጎግ፡ ወባዕዳንሰ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ተፈነዉ፡ ኀበ፡ አባግዕ፡ እለ፡ ተገድፉ፡ ወጸውዑ፡ ሰብአ፡ ውስተ፡ አሚን፡ ወአጥመ ቅዎሙ፡ በከመ፡ አዘዞሙ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ በስመ፡ አብ፡ ወወልድ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ እስከ፡ ተፈልጡ፡ እምዓለም፡ ወሖሩ፡ ውስተ፡ ዕረፍት፡ ወፍሥሓ፡ ዘለዓለም፡ ወእምቅድመ፡ ይትፈለጡ፡ ውስተ፡ አህጉር፡ ገብሩ፡ ሥርዐተ፡ ወቀኖና፡ ወአዘዝዎሙ፡ ለእለ፡ አምኑ፡ ወመሀርዎሙ፡ ኪያሃ፡ ወአጽንዕዎሙ፡ ባቲ፡

people by his sorcery and his apostasy. And he went thither, and all its people believed by his hand, and he baptized them all; and further the people of Antioch and Spain and the cities that lie around them, and all Rome.

And God destroyed Simon the sorcerer by the petition and the prayer of the saint; and the faith appeared through all that land by his holiness, his purity, and his patience. And John the evangelist in Ephesus, Thessalonica, Asia, Tyre, and Achaia, and all the land of Phrygia. And Andrew the brother of Simon, in Nicaea and in Nicomedia, and all the land of Dinunya and its districts, from its border. And Luke the writer of the Gospel, in Zanṭiya and in Barqiya and Frqiya and what lies around it, as far as the districts of the west, as far as the great sea. And Marmari, of the seventy disciples,[vii] in Daset, Persia, the land of Babylon and all Salamt and those around them, the land of Teman and the islands, the land of Arabia, those who dwell in tents, as far as the Sea of Yam. And Akay, his disciple, the disciple of Marmari, in the land of Adbar, Aḥwaz, and Tarsus, as far as the land of Sind, and as far as Gog and Magog. But the other Apostles were sent to the sheep that had been cast off, and they called men to the faith and baptized them, as our Lord Christ ordered them, in the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit, until they were taken from the world and went into rest and everlasting joy. And, before they were separated into the cities, they made ordinance and canon, and gave command to those who had believed, and taught them the

[vii] On the '*seventy disciples*' see Lk 10:1–12.

አመ፡ ሀለዉ፡ ጉቡኣን፡ በጽዮን። ወእምዝ፡ ተፈልጡ፡ ወመሀሩ፡ በኵልሄ፡ ለእለ፡ አምኑ፡ በእደዊሆሙ፡ እምኵሉ፡ በሓውርት፡ ጎበ፡ ሖሩ።

same, and strengthened them in it, while they were gathered in Zion. Then they were separated and taught everywhere those who believed by their hands, in all the regions they went to.

፩፡ ትእዛዝ።

ከመ፡ ይኩን፡ ጸሎቶሙ፡ መንገለ፡ ምሥራቅ፡ እስመ፡ ይቤ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ከመ፡ ይመጽእ፡ ለሊሁ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ እምሰማይ፡ በደኃሪ፡ መዋዕል፡ ከመ፡ መብረቅ፡ ዘይወፅእ፡ እምሥራቅ፡ ወያስተሬኢ፡ እስከ፡ ምዕራብ፡ ወበእንተዝ፡ አእመርነ፡ ከመ፡ ምጽአቱ፡ ይከውን፡ እምሥራቅ።

ORDER 1

[i] Let their prayer be toward the east; for our Lord Jesus Christ said that God himself will come from heaven in the last days, like the lightning that goes out from the east and shines as far as the west. And by this we knew that his coming will be from the east.

ORDER 1

[i] The Syriac text reads: *The holy Apostles appointed: be praying toward the east, because as the lightning shines from the east and is seen as far as the west, so shall be the coming of the Son of Man. By this let us know and consider that our Lord Christ will appear from the east, out of heaven.*

፪፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ሰንበተ፡ ክርስቲያን።

ከመ፡ ይትጋብኡ፡ በበእሑድ፡ በሠለስቱ፡ ሰዐት፡ ለጸሎት፡ ወአንብቦ፡ መጻሕፍት፡ ዘትካት፡ ወዘሐዲስ፡ ወአቅርቦ፡ ቍርባን፡ እስመ፡ ባቲ፡ ዜናዋ፡ መልአክ፡ ለማርያም፡ ከመ፡ ትፀንስ፡ ክርስቶስሃ፡ ወባቲ፡ ተንሥአ፡ እምውታን፡ ወባቲ፡ ይወርድ፡ እምሰማይ፡ በዕለተ፡ ትንሣኤ፡ ምስለ፡ መላእክቲሁ፡ በዐቢይ፡ ስብሐት፡ ወይነብር፡ ምስለ፡ አርዳኢሁ፡ ቅዱሳን፡ ወይኴንን፡ ሕያዋነ፡ ወምውታነ።

ORDER 2

CONCERNING THE CHRISTIAN SABBATH

[i] Let them assemble on every Sunday at the third hour for prayer, and for the reading of the books of the old covenant and of the new, and for the offering of the oblation; for on it the angel announced to Mary that she would conceive Christ, and on it he rose from the dead, and on it he will come down from heaven on the day of resurrection with his angels in great glory, and will sit with his holy disciples and judge the living and the dead.

[i] The Syriac text has '*Lord's Day*' in place of '*Christian Sabbath*'.

፫፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ዕለተ፡ ረቡዕ።

ከመ፡ ይግበሩ፡ ጸሎተ፡ ተጋቢኦሙ፡ በዕለተ፡ ረቡዕ፡ እስመ፡ ባቲ፡ ነገሮሙ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ከመ፡ ይነሥእዎ፡ ወይሰቅልዎ፡ ወይመውት፡ ወይትነሣእ፡ በሣልስት፡ ዕለት፡ ወሐዘኑ፡ ወተከዙ፡ በእንቲአሁ።

ORDER 3

CONCERNING THE FOURTH DAY

Let them make prayer, assembling on the fourth day;[i] for, on it, Jesus told them that they would seize him and crucify him, and that he would die and rise on the third day; and they grieved and were troubled on his account.

[i] The '*fourth day*' is Wednesday.

፬፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ዐርብ።

ከመ፡ ይግበሩ፡ ጸሎተ፡ በዕለተ፡ ዐርብ፡ በ፱፡ ሰዐት፡ እስመ፡ በጽሐ፡ ዘነገሮሙ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ በረቡዕ፡ በእንተ፡ ሕማሙ፡ ወስቅለቱ፡ በዕለተ፡ ዐርብ። ወተጠየቀ፡ ውእቱ፡ አመ፡ አድለቅለቀት፡ ምድር፡ ወጸልመ፡ ፀሐይ፡ በይእቲ፡ ዕለት።

ORDER 4

CONCERNING THE SIXTH DAY

Let them make prayer on the sixth day[i] at the ninth hour; for, what Christ told them on the fourth day concerning his passion and his crucifixion was fulfilled on the sixth day. And he was made known when the earth quaked and the sun grew dark on that day.

[i] The '*sixth day*' is Friday.

፭፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ሊቃውንት።

ከመ፡ ይሚሙ፡ ሎሙ፡ መሀይምናን፡ ሊቃውንተ፡ ሊቃነ፡ ጳጳሳት፡ ወጳጳሳተ፡ ወኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳተ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩኑ፡ በአርአያ፡ ሙሴ፡ ወአሮን፡ ሊቃነ፡ ካህናት፡ ወይአዝዙ፡ ለኵሉ፡ ሕዝብ።

ORDER 5

CONCERNING THE ELDERS

Let the faithful appoint for themselves elders – archbishops, and bishops, and episcopal overseers – that they may be after the pattern of Moses and Aaron, chiefs of the priests, and that they may command all the people.

፮፡ ትእዛዝ።

ORDER 6

ከመ፡ ይሚሙ፡ ቀሳውስተ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩኑ፡ በአርአያ፡ ካህናተ፡ ደቂቀ፡ እስራኤል።

[i] Let them appoint presbyters, that they may be after the pattern of the priests of the children of Israel.

ORDER 6

[i] The Syriac text merges this and the following order with Order 5.

፯፡ ትእዛዝ።

ከመ፡ ይሚሙ፡ ዲያቆናተ፡ ወንፍቀ፡ ዲያቆናተ፡ ወአናጕንስጢሰ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩኑ፡ ለመልእክት፡ ከመ፡ ደቂቀ፡ ሌዊ፡ ወይጸውሩ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቍርባን፡ ወንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ መቅደስ፡ ወንዋየ፡ መሥዋዕት።

ORDER 7

[i] Let them appoint deacons, subdeacons, and readers, so they may be for the ministry like the children of Levi, and that they may carry the vessels of the oblation, and the vessels of the house of the sanctuary, and the vessels of the sacrifice.

[i] The Syriac text merges this and the previous order with Order 5.

፰፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ልደት።

ወይግበሩ፡ በዓለ፡ ልደቱ፡ ለእግዚእነ፡ በበዐመት፡ በዕለተ፡ ተወልደ፡ አመ፡ ፳ወ፱፡ ለወርኀ፡ ታኅሣሥ፡ እስመ፡ ውእቱ፡ ርእሰ፡ ኵሉ፡ በዓላት።

ORDER 8

CONCERNING THE NATIVITY

[i] Let them keep the feast of the nativity of our Lord yearly, on the day he was born, on the twenty-ninth of the month of Tahsas; for it is the head of all the feasts.

[i] This is ‘Tradition 6’ in the Syriac text.

፱፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ጥምቀት።

ወይግበሩ፡ በዓለ፡ ጥምቀቱ፡ ለእግዚእነ፡ እስመ፡ ዕለተ፡ ቅዳሴ፡ ይእቲ፡ አመ፡ ተጠምቀ፡ እምዮሐንስ፡ መጥምቅ፡ ዘውእቱ፡ ፲ወ፩፡ ለጥር።

ORDER 9

CONCERNING BAPTISM

[i] Let them keep the feast of the baptism of our Lord, for it is the day of sanctification, when he was baptized by John the Baptist, which is the 11th of Tir.

ORDER 9

[i] The Syriac text merges this with the previous Order and reads: *The holy Apostles appointed further: keep the day of the nativity of our Lord on the twenty-fifth of December, for this is the head of all feasts; and the feast of Epiphany on the sixth of January, according to the extended reckoning of the Greeks.*

፲፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ጾመ፡ ፋሲካ።

ወይጹሙ፡ በበ፴ወ፬ት፡ ፴፡ ዕለተ፡ በከመ፡ ጾሙ፡ ሙሴ፡ ወኤልያስ፡ ወነቢያት፡ በቀዳሚ፡ ወአኀዘ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ከማሁ፡ በሥጋሁ፡ ወአዖቀ፡ ከመ፡ ይግበርዎ፡ እምቅድመ፡ ሕማማቲሁ፡ ወይዘከሩ፡ ሕማሞ፡ ለክርስቶስ፡ ወስቅለቶ፡ ወሞቶ፡ ወርደቶ፡ ውስተ፡ መቃብር። ወበዕለተ፡ ትንሣኤሁ፡ ይግበሩ፡ ፋሲካ፡ ወይግበሩ፡ በዓለ፡ በተፍጻሜተ፡ ጾም፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ሰናብት፡ ወእሑድ፡ ጸዊሞሙ፡ ፴፡ ዕለተ፡ ወዕለተ፡ ዐርብ፡ ወቀዳሚት፡ ሰንበት፡ ክልኤሆን፡ በዕለተ፡ ተሰቅለ፡ ወተቀብረ፡ ወዕለተ፡ እሑድ፡ ትንሣኤሁ፡ [3] ወእልቦ፡ እምድኅረ፡ እሉ፡ መዋዕል፡ ጾመ፡ እስከ፡ ተፍጻሜተ፡ ፶፡ ዕለት።

ORDER 10

CONCERNING THE FAST OF PASCHA

[i] Let them fast 40 days yearly, as Moses and Elijah and the prophets fasted in the beginning, and as our Lord Jesus Christ undertook the like in his flesh; and he made it known that they should do it before his passion, and that they should remember the passion of Christ and his crucifixion and his death and his descent into the tomb. And, on the day of his resurrection, let them keep Pascha, and let them keep the feast at the completion of the fast, having fasted 40 days, the sabbaths and the Sunday excepted; and the day of Friday and the first sabbath, both of them, on the day he was crucified and buried; and the day of Sunday, his resurrection. And there is no fast after these days until the completion of 50 days.

ORDER 10

[i] This is 'Tradition 7' in the Syriac text, which reads: *The holy Apostles appointed again: be fasting forty days before the passion of our Saviour, and then keep the day of his passion and the day of his resurrection; because our Lord also, the Lord of the feast, fasted forty days; and Moses and Elijah, who bore the figure of this mystery, themselves fasted forty days, and then appeared in glory.* Throughout this order, the Ge'ez has '*40*' and '*50*' expressed as numerals (፵ & ፶).

፲፩፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ በዓለ፡ ፵።

ወይግበሩ፡ በዓለ፡ ዕርገቱ፡ ለእግዚእነ፡ ውስተ፡ ሰማይ፡ እምድኅረ፡ ትንሣኤሁ፡ በ፵፡ ዕለት።

ORDER 11

CONCERNING THE FEAST OF THE 40

[i] Let them keep the feast of the ascension of our Lord into heaven, after his resurrection, on the 40th day.

ORDER 11

[i] This is 'Tradition 8' in the Syriac text, which reads: *The holy Apostles judged besides: at the end of the forty days following the resurrection of our Lord, make the commemoration of his Ascension to his Father.*

፲፪፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ አንብቦ፡ መጻሕፍት፡

ወያንብቡ፡ መጻሕፍተ፡ በዲበ፡ መንበር፡ ልዑል፡ በቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ እምኦሪት፡ ወመጻሕፍተ፡ ኵሉ፡ ነቢያት፡ ወዘሐዋርያት፡ ዜናሆሙ። ወእምድኅሬሁ፡ ያንብቡ፡ እምወንጌል፡ እስመ፡ ውእቱ፡ ተፍጻሜተ፡ ኵሉ፡ መጻሕፍት፡ ወይስምዑ፡ ኵሉ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ቀዊሞሙ፡ በእገሪሆሙ፡ እስመ፡ ዜና፡ ሕይወት፡ ወመድኀኒት፡ ውእቱ፡ ወጸጋ፡ ለኵሉ፡ ሰብእ፡ ወይደሉ፡ ያዕቢይዎ፡ እምኵሉ፡ መጻሕፍት፡ ወይስአሉ፡ ሰብእ፡ ኀበ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ እንዘ፡ ይትነበብ።

ORDER 12

CONCERNING THE READING OF THE BOOKS

[i] Let them read the books upon a high seat in the church, from the Orit and the books of all the prophets and the accounts of the apostles. And after it let them read from the Gospel, for it is the completion of all the books; and let all the people hear it standing upon their feet, for it is the tidings of life and of salvation, and grace for all men; and it is fitting that they magnify it above all the books, and that men make petition to God while it is being read.

ORDER 12

[i] The Syriac text divides this Order into two parts, separating the Old and New Testaments.

፲፫፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ሥርዐተ፡ ሢመት።

ወኢይሠየም፡ ላዕለ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ወኢይአዝዞሙ፡ ዘኢያአምር፡ ሕገ፡ ወሥርዐተ፡ አላ፡ ዘይገብር፡ ባቲ፡ ወይከውን፡ ጌረ፡ በግዕዙ፡ ወተዐጋሲ፡ በትሕትና፡ ወሠናይ፡ በፍናዊሁ። ወእመሰ፡ ወለጠ፡ ዘንተ፡ ወኢገብረ፡ ኵሎ፡ ዘነገርነ፡ ይስዐር፡ እምሢመቱ፡ በኀይል፡ ወኢይትወከፍዎ፡ ቃሎ፡ ወትእዛዞ፡ እስመ፡ ኢኮነ፡ መእመነ፡ በሠሪያቱ።

ORDER 13

CONCERNING THE ORDER OF APPOINTMENT

[i] Let him not be appointed over Christians, nor command them, who does not know the law and the order; but rather he who practises it, and who is good in his conduct, and forbearing in humility, and good in his ways. And if he alters this and does not do all that we have said, let him be removed from his office by force, and let them not receive his word nor his command, for he is not faithful in his ordering.

ORDER 13

[i] The Syriac text is shorter: *The Apostles laid down again that he who does not know the faith of the church, and the orders and the laws set down in it, be neither ruler nor teacher; and that he who knows them and transgresses them minister no longer, because he is not sincere, but a liar in his ministry.*

፲፬፡ ትእዛዝ።

ካዕበ፡በእንተ፡ሢመት።

ወይክልእዎ፡ ሢመተ፡ ወመልእክተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ወኰንኖ፡ ማእከለ፡ ሰብእ፡ ለዝኒ፡ ዘይደፍር፡ መሐላ፡ ሐሰት፡ ወስምዐ፡ ሐሰት፡ ወተዐቅፎ፡ ላዕለ፡ ሰብእ፡ ወዘየሐሚዮሙ፡ በዘኢገብሩ።

ORDER 14

MORE CONCERNING APPOINTMENT

[i] Let them withhold office and the ministry of the church, and let him be judged among men, from everyone who dares a false oath and false testimony, and who gives offence against men, and who accuses them of what they have not done.

ORDER 14

[i] This is 'Tradition 12' in the Syriac text, which reads: *The Apostles prescribed likewise that he who swears and lies and speaks false testimony, or goes to magicians and diviners and Chaldaean tricksters, and observes lots and nativities and all that those hold who know not God, be cast down from the ministry, and minister no more.*

፲፭፡ ትእዛዝ።

ወይእተት፡ እምኂሙት፡ ኵሉ፡ ዘይትአመን፡ በሐሳበ፡ ከዋክብት፡ ወየአምን፡ በነገረ፡ ማርያን፡ ወሰብአ፡ ሥራይ፡ ወረአይተ፡ ኮከብ፡ ወሐሳበ፡ ልደት፡ ወይሴአሎሙ፡ በእንተ፡ ዘኢይደልዎ፡ ወይትወከፍ፡ ቃሎሙ፡ ወያሰትት፡ ትእዛዘ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወሥርዐቶ፡ ወኵነኔሁ፡ ወይዔርዮሙ፡ ለክርስቲያን፡ ምስለ፡ እለ፡ ኢያአምርዎ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ለይደቅ፡ እምኂመተ፡ ክህነት፡ እስመ፡ ገብረ፡ ከመ፡ አይሁድ፡ መጠዓዊያን።

ORDER 15

[i] Let everyone be put out of office who trusts in the reckoning of the stars, and who believes in the word of the diviners and the men of sorcery and the gazers on stars and the reckoning of birth, and who asks them concerning what is not lawful for him, and receives their word, and nullifies the command of God and his order and his judgment, and makes Christians equal with those who do not know God: let him fall from the office of the priesthood; for, he has acted as the Jews who fell away.

[i] This Order is not included in the Syriac text.

፲፮፡ ትእዛዝ።

ወለእመ፡ ሀለወ፡ ውስተ፡ መልእክተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ዘይናፍቅ፡ በመልእክቱ፡ ወኢይትአመን፡ ባቲ፡ ወኢይአምንዎ፡ ዲቤሃ፡ ይክልእዎ፡ እምኒመቱ፡ እስመ፡ ኢኮነ፡ መእመነ፡ ወኢሠናየ፡ በመልእክቱ፡ ወባሕቱ፡ ያአብድ፡ ሰብአ፡ ወርእሶሂ፡ እስመ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ኢይፈቅድ፡ ጽልሑተ።

ORDER 16

[i] And if there is in the ministry of the church one who has doubt in his ministry, and does not trust in it, and they do not trust him over it, let them withhold him from his office; for he is not faithful nor good in his ministry, but rather makes men foolish, and himself also; for God does not desire impurity.

ORDER 16

[i] This is 'Tradition 13' in the Syriac text, which reads: *The Apostles appointed also that if any doubts concerning the ministry, and does not hold it firm and settled, he shall minister no more; because the Lord of the ministry is not sure to him, and he deceives men — yet not God, before whom no deceits stand.*

፲፯፡ ትእዛዝ።

ወይስዐር፡ እምኒመቱ፡ ኵሉ፡ ቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡ ዘይትዐወቅ፡ በዝሙት፡ ወሥሥዕት፡ ወይኅሥሥ፡ በዝንቱ፡ ዓለም።

ORDER 17

[i] Let every presbyter and deacon be removed from his office who is known in fornication and in greed, and who seeks after this world.

ORDER 17

[i] This is ‘Tradition 14’ in the Syriac text, which reads: *The Apostles appointed also that he who lends and takes usury, and practises the trade of greed, shall likewise not minister, nor remain in his ministry.*

፲፰፡ ትእዛዝ።

ወኢይሀሉ፡ ውስተ፡ ሢመት፡ ወመልእክተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ወኢይደመር፡ ምስለ፡ ካህናት፡ ዘያፈቅሮሙ፡ ለአይሁድ፡ ወዘይከውን፡ ዐርከሙ፡ ከመ፡ አስቆሮታዊ፡ ወኢመፍቀሬ፡ መሰግላን፡ እለ፡ ያመልኩ፡ ጣዖተ። ወዘከመዝ፡ ግዕዙ፡ ያውፅእዎ፡ እምኔሆሙ፡ ወኢይጎድግዎ፡ ማእከሎሙ፡ ወኢይትለአክ፡ ምስሌሆሙ፡ ወኢይሳተፎሙ።

ORDER 18

[i] Let him not be in office nor in the ministry of the church, and let him not be joined with the priests, who loves the Jews and becomes their friend like the Iscariot, nor a lover of the diviners who worship idols. And him whose conduct is such let them put out from among them, and let them not leave him in their midst, and let him not minister with them nor partake with them.

ORDER 18

[i] The Syriac text reads: *The Apostles appointed again that he who loves the Jews, as Judas Iscariot loved them, or the heathen, who worship the creature in place of the Creator, shall not come in among them; and if he is among them, let them not leave him, but let him be separated from them, and let him not minister with them.*

፲፱፡ ትእዛዝ።

ወይትወከፍዎ፡ ለኵሉ፡ ዘይመጽእ፡ ውስተ፡ አሚን፡ ወይደምርዎ፡ ምስሌሆሙ፡ ወኢይክልእዎ፡ ሐዊረ፡ ጎበ፡ ሰብኡ፡ እምአይሁድ፡ ወመምለኪያነ፡ ጣዖት፡ ወለእመ፡ ገብአ፡ ጎበ፡ ዘትካት፡ ግብሩ፡ እምድኅረ፡ ትድምርት፡ ወእምዝ፡ ተመይጠ፡ ጎበ፡ እለ፡ ኢየአምኑ፡ ኢይትወከፍዎ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ከመ፡ መምለኪያነ፡ ጣዖት።

ORDER 19

[i] Let them receive everyone who comes into the faith, and let them join him with them, and let them not forbid him going to his own people, from among the Jews and the worshippers of idols. And if after the joining he returns to his former deed, and then turns to those who do not believe, let them not receive him except as the worshippers of idols.

ORDER 19

[i] This is 'Tradition 16' in the Syriac text, which reads: *The Apostles judged again that if any comes from among the Jews or from among the heathen and joins himself to them, or having joined himself turns back and goes again to the side where he formerly stood — and if he returns and comes to them a second time — he shall not be received again; but look upon him as belonging to that side in which he was of old, as men who know him.*

፳፡ ትእዛዝ።

ወኢይግበሩ፡ ሊቀ፡ ዘይኤዝዝ፡ ለቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ዘይገብር፡ ግብረ፡ ዝንቱ፡ ዓለም። ወኢይደመር፡ ውስተ፡ ነገረ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክረ፡ ቢጹ፡ እለ፡ ቀደምዎ፡ እለ፡ ያቀውሙ፡ ጸሎተ፡ ከማሁ። ወኢይደሉ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክሩ፡ ወምክሮሙ፡ ኅቡረ፡ በዘያሠምሮ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ወዘይደልዎሙ፡ ለሕዝብ፡ ወርቱዕ፡ ኮነኔሁ። ወኢይኩን፡ በፍትሑ፡ ዘያሐሥም፡ ለመንፈቆሙ፡ ወኢጋእዘ፡ በተዐድዎ፡ ርትዕ። ወዘከመዝ፡ ግዕዙ፡ ይትፈለጥ። ወኢይኅድግ፡ ቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡ ጸሎቱ፡ ዘአኀዘ፡ ወኢይፃእ፡ ኀበ፡ ነገረ፡ ባዕድ። ወዘገብረ፡ ከመዝ፡ ኢይከውኖ፡ ይግባእ፡ ኀበ፡ መካኑ፡ ዘቀዲሙ።

ORDER 20

[i] Let them not make as chief, to command the church of God, one who does the work of this world. And let him not be joined to the business of the people save by the counsel of his colleagues who preceded him, who likewise set up prayer; and it is not fitting save by his counsel and theirs together, in what pleases God and what is fitting for the people, and his judgment right. And let there not be in his judging one who does ill to a part of them, nor one arrogant in overstepping rectitude; and him whose conduct is such, let him be separated. And let not the presbyter nor the deacon abandon the prayer he has begun, and let him not go out to another business; and he who does so, it is not possible for him to return to his former place.

ORDER 20

[i] This is ‘Tradition 17’ in the Syriac text, which reads: *The Apostles appointed also that the ruler cannot, apart from those who minister with him, be the administrator of the things which belong to the church; but that it be ordered by the counsel of all, and that be done which is our Lord’s, and in which all consent and none dissent.*

፳፩፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ተዝካር።

ወይግበሩ፡ ለኵሉ፡ ሰማዕት፡ መሀይምናን፡ እለ፡ ተክዕወ፡ ደሞሙ፡ በእንተ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ እግዚእነ፡ በተአምኖ፡ ተዝካሮሙ፡ በዕለተ፡ ተከለሉ።

ORDER 21

CONCERNING COMMEMORATION

[i] Let them make, for every faithful martyr whose blood was poured out for Christ our Lord in confession, their commemoration on the day they were crowned.

ORDER 21

[i] This is 'Tradition 18' in the Syriac text, which reads: *The Apostles appointed again that of all those who go out of this world with a good testimony of the faith of Christ, and with tribulation for his name, you make commemoration on the day of their slaying.*

፳፪፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ሥርዐተ፡ ጸሎት።

ወያብዝኑ፡ ጸሎተ፡ በሌሊት፡ ወመዓልት፡ በመዝሙረ፡ ዳዊት፡ ወይጎልዩ፡ ጸሎተ፡ ባቲ፡ እስመ፡ ይቤ፡ እባርኮ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ በኵሉ፡ ጊዜ፡ ወዘልፈ፡ ስብሐቲሁ፡ ውስተ፡ አፉየ። ወካዕበ፡ ይቤ፡ ጥዑም፡ ለጕርዔየ፡ ነቢብከ፡ እመዓር፡ ወሶካር፡ ጥዕሚ፡ ለአፉየ። ወበእንተዝ፡ ይደሉ፡ አንብቦ፡ በዜማ፡ ጥዑም፡ በእንተ፡ አዕቢዮ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወስባሔሁ፡ ወአእኵቶ፡ ጸጋሁ፡ ወስኢል፡ ጎቤሁ፡ ወአሠንዮ፡ በኵሉ፡ በእንተ፡ ስሙ፡ ግሩም፡ ወቅዱስ። ወካዕበ፡ ይነግር፡ በእንተ፡ ተፀምዶ፡ ወስባሔ፡ ወተጋንዮ፡ ወተአምኖ፡ ኀጣውኢ፡ ወስእለታት፡ ዘይደልዎሙ፡ ለመሀይምናን። ይጸልዩ፡ ባቲ፡ ሶበ፡ ይረክቦሙ፡ ምንዳቤ፡ ወሐዘን፡ ወተጽናስ፡ ወያመሥጡ፡ እመንሱት።

ORDER 22

CONCERNING THE ORDER OF PRAYER

[i] Let them multiply prayer by night and by day in the Psalter of David, and let them chant prayer in it; for he said, “I will bless the Lord at all times, and continually his praise is in my mouth.” And again he said, “Sweet to my throat is your speech, sweeter than honey and sugar to my mouth.” And, for this reason, it is fitting to read in sweet melody, for the magnifying of God and his praise, and the thanking of his grace, and petition to him, and doing well in all things for the sake of his name, awesome and holy. [ii] Again, it speaks of devotion, praise, thanksgiving, confession of sins, and petitions fitting for the faithful. They pray with it when they encounter tribulation, and sorrow, and distress, and they are saved from harm.

ORDER 22

[i] A much shorter version of this is ‘Tradition 19’ in the Syriac text, which reads: *The Apostles appointed again that in the ministry of the church you say the praises of David daily, because of that which is written: I will bless the Lord at all times; and, his praise shall be in my mouth at all times; and, day and night I will meditate, and will speak, and will make my voice heard before you.*

[ii] Lumpkin lacks the last two sentences.

፳፫፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ኀልቈ፡ ካህናት።

ወይኩኑ፡ ላእካን፡ ሰብዐቱ፡ እለ፡ ተኀርዩ፡ እምሕዝብ፡ ለመልእክተ፡ ቤተ፡ መቅደስ፡ ኄራን፡ ወሠናያን፡ ወልብዋነ፡ ጥበብ፡ ወአእምሮ፡ ወፈራህያነ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ እለ፡ ያአምሩ፡ ሥርዐቶ፡ እስመ፡ እሙንቱ፡ እለ፡ ይነግሩ፡ በእንተ፡ ጸሎት። ወይቀድሱ፡ ቍርባነ፡ ወይዕርቁ፡ ሕዝበ፡ በዳጎን፡ ወሰላም፡ እስመ፡ እሙንቱ፡ ውሉደ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በአማን፡ በከመ፡ ተብህለ፡ በወንጌል፡ ቅዱስ። ወላእካነ፡ ትንቢት፡ ወይኩኑ፡ እስትርኩባነ፡ ኢይትሀወኩ፡ በግብረ፡ ዓለም፡ አላ፡ ይኩን፡ ግብሮሙ፡ መልእክቶ፡ ለአእምሮ፡ ሕጉ።

ORDER 23

CONCERNING THE NUMBER OF THE PRIESTS

[i] Let the ministers be seven, chosen from the people for the ministry of the house of the sanctuary: good and goodly, endowed with wisdom and knowledge, and fearers of God who know his order; for, they are the ones who speak concerning prayer. And let them consecrate the oblation, and dismiss the people in safety and peace; for they are truly the children of God, as was said in the holy Gospel. And let them be ministers of prophecy, not troubled with the work of the world, but let their work be its ministry, for the knowledge of his law.

ORDER 23

[i] At this point, the '*Traditions*' in the Syriac text do not match those of the Ge'ez '*Orders*'. For 'Tradition 20', the Syriac reads: *The Apostles appointed again that those who are emptied of mammon, and who do not run after the gain of money, be the men chosen and brought forward to the ministry of the altar.* The correspondence returns at Order 25.

፳፬፡ ትእዛዝ።

ORDER 24

ወይኩን፡ ሊቅ፡ ዘይኤዝዞሙ፡ ለሕዝብ፡ ወይጌሥጾሙ፡ በመስቀል፡ እስመ፡ ንኤዝዝ፡ ወአኮ፡ ዘነአስር፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ርትዕ። ወእመሰ፡ ተወገሎሙ፡ ካህን፡ እንዘ፡ ንጹሓን፡ እሙንቱ፡ ይሚሙ፡ ዲቤሁ፡ ካህናተ፡ በርትዕ፡ ወለእመ፡ ተስእኖሙ፡ ይሰድዎ፡ ኀበ፡ ጳጳስ፡ አው፡ ኀበ፡ ሊቀ፡ ጳጳሳት፡ ወያቅምዎ፡ በርትዕ፡ ወኢይኅድግዎ፡ ይትዐደው፡ ላዕለ፡ አባግዐ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ እለ፡ ተሣየጦሙ፡ በደሙ፡ ክቡር። ወኢያምዕዕዎሙ፡ ከመ፡ ኢይፃኡ፡ ውስተ፡ ፅርፈት፡ ላዕለ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወክሒድ፡ ለስሙ፡ ቅዱስ። ወይኩኑ፡ መሀይምናን፡ ጌራነ፡ ዘይትዔገሡ፡ ግፍዐ፡ በከመ፡ ይደሉ፡ ከመ፡ ይትበቀል፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በእንቲአሆሙ። ወኢያድሉ፡ ሢዮም፡ በፍትሕ፡ ማእከለ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ወይሥልጥ፡ ኵነኔሁ። ወዘሰ፡ ያጸድቆ፡ ለዐማጺ፡ በእንተ፡ ዘይሁቦ፡ ወይዔምዖ፡ ለንጹሕ፡ በእንተ፡ ድካሙ፡ ወንዴቱ፡ ውእቱ፡ ይከውን፡ ውጉዘ፡ ወርጉመ፡ ወኢይረስይዎ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ከመ፡ መምለኬ፡ ጣዖት። ወይክልእዎ፡ ሢመቶ፡ ለዘ፡ ይገብር፡ ከመዝ፡ ወይዘልፍዎ፡ በእንተ፡ ዐመፃሁ፡ ወኢያፍርህከ፡ ጵጵስናሁ።

[i] Let there be a chief commanding the people and reproving them by the cross; for, we command and do not bind without rectitude. And, if the priest oppresses them while they are innocent, let them appoint priests over him in rectitude; and, if they are unable, let them send him to the bishop, or to the archbishop, and let them set him right in rectitude, and let them not leave him to transgress against the sheep of Christ, bought with his precious blood. And let them not provoke them, lest they go out into blasphemy against God and denial of his holy name. And let the faithful be good, who endure injustice as is fitting, so God may avenge on their behalf. And let the appointed one not show partiality in judgment among the people; and let his judgment prevail. And, as for him who justifies the oppressor for what he gives him, and oppresses the innocent because of his weakness and his poverty – he becomes accursed and cursed, and let them reckon him as nothing other than a worshipper of idols. And let them withhold his office from him who does so; and let them rebuke him for his injustice; and let his episcopacy not make you afraid.

ORDER 24

[i] The last part of this canon vaguely resembles ‘Tradition 21’ in the Syriac text, which reads: *The Apostles appointed again that the priest who binds rashly, without just cause, justly receive punishment; yet that he who has been bound receive the binding as one who is justly bound.*

፳፭፡ ትእዛዝ።

ወኢይሀሉ፡ ውስተ፡ ሚመት፡ ወኢይቅረብ፡ ዘይትዔበይ፡ በነፍሱ፡ ወይዜሀር፡ ላዕለ፡ ሰብእ፡ ወይሬኢ፡ ነፍሶ፡ ከመ፡ ዘይዐቢ፡ እምሰብእ፡ ወይከብር፡ ወይጌይስ፡ ወይሬኢዮሙ፡ ለሕዝበ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በዐይነ፡ መንኖ። አላ፡ ውእቱ፡ ምኑን፡ በኀበ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወጎሱር፡ ዘአልቦ፡ ሠናየ፡ ዝክረ፡ በሕይወቱ፡ ወኢምሕረተ፡ በኀበ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በሞቱ፡ ወስዑር፡ እምክህነቱ። ዘበእንቲአሁ፡ ይቤ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በመጽሐፍ፡ እመይጣ፡ ለጸጋ፡ ኀበ፡ ካልእ፡ እምእለ፡ ይትዔበዩ።

ORDER 25

Let him not be in office, and let him not draw near, who exalts himself in his soul, and boasts over men, and sees his soul as greater than theirs, and as honoured and better, and looks upon the people of God with an eye of contempt. But he is contemptible before God, and shameful, who has no good memorial in his life nor mercy before God at his death, and is removed from his priesthood; concerning whom God said in the scripture, “I will turn the grace to another, away from those who exalt themselves.” [i]

ORDER 25

[i] It is not clear which passage of scripture is being cited here; possibly, it is an adaptation of Mt 23:12, which reads: *Anyone who exalts himself up will be humbled and anyone who humbles himself will be exalted.*

፳፮፡ ትእዛዝ።

ወይሚሙ፡ ሊቀ፡ ካህናተ፡ ላዕለ፡ ቀሳውስተ፡ በሐውርት፡ ዘየዐውድ፡ ማእከሎሙ፡ ወይዋሒዮሙ፡ ወይአዝዞሙ፡ ወይገሥጾሙ፡ ወያእምሩ፡ ከመ፡ ሥሉጥ፡ ውእቱ፡ ላዕሌሆሙ፡ ወያእምር፡ ግብሮሙ፡ ወይደልዎሙ፡ ይግበሩ፡ ትእዛዞ፡ በከመ፡ ሳሙኤል፡ ነቢይ፡ ዘያደ፡ በአድያመ፡ ኢየሩሳሌም፡ ወአዘዞሙ፡ ወገሠጾሙ።

ORDER 26

[i] Let them appoint a chief of priests over the presbyters in the regions, who goes among them, visits them, commands them, and reproves them; and let them know that he has authority over them; and let him know their work; and it is fitting for them that they do his command – as Samuel the prophet, who went round in the districts of Jerusalem, and commanded them and reproved them.

ORDER 26

[i] In the Syriac text, this is 'Tradition 24'; it reads: *The Apostles appointed likewise that there be visitors over the presbyters who are in the towns, and that the head of them all be known; for through his hand all are sought. For, Samuel went thus from place to place.*

፳፯፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ንጉሥ።

ወይኩን፡ ምቅዋሙ፡ ለንጉሥ፡ ምስለ፡ መሀይምናን፡ በጊዜ፡ ጸሎት፡ ቅድመ፡ ኵሎሙ፡ ሰብእ፡ ወይቁም፡ ምስለ፡ ሊቃውንት፡ ወሚዩማን፡ ካህናት፡ ወይባእ፡ ምስሌሆሙ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዕ፡ ወይኩን፡ ምቅዋሙ፡ በህየ፡ እስመ፡ ዳዊት፡ ንጉሥ፡ ወእለ፡ ይትማሰልዎ፡ ነገሥት፡ ይቀድምዎሙ፡ ለኵሉ፡ ሰብእ፡ በውስተ፡ ጸሎት፡ ወይበውኡ፡ ቤተ፡ መቅደስ፡ ወቦሙ፡ ምቅዋመ፡ በውስጥ።

ORDER 27

CONCERNING THE KING

[i] Let the king's station be with the faithful at the time of prayer, before all the people; and let him stand with the elders and the appointed priests; and let him enter with them into the altar, and let his station be there; for, David the king, and the kings who are like him, precede all the people in prayer, and they enter the house of the sanctuary, and they have a station within.

ORDER 27

[i] In the Syriac text, this is 'Tradition 25'; it reads: *The Apostles appointed again that to kings who shall believe in Christ there be power to go up and to stand before the altar together with the ruler of the church; because David also, and those who were like him, went up and stood before the altar.*

፳፰፡ ትእዛዝ።

ኢይትጎበል፡ ንጉሥ፡ ገቢረ፡ በቤተ፡ መቅደስ፡ በፈቃደ፡ ርእሱ፡ አላ፡ በፈሪሀ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወበጎሩት፡ ከመ፡ ይሠቅ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ መንበሮ፡ በጽድቅ፡ ወያኑኅ፡ መዋዕሊሁ፡ ወያውርሶ፡ ጸጋ፡ ዘለዓለም፡ መንፈሳዌ፡ ወኢይክልአ፡ ውሉደ፡ እለ፡ ይነብሩ፡ ዲበ፡ መንበሩ፡ እስከ፡ ለዓለም።

ORDER 28

[i] Let the king not presume to act in the house of the sanctuary by his own will, but in the fear of God and in goodness, so that God may uphold his throne in righteousness, and lengthen his days, and give him as inheritance eternal spiritual grace, and not withhold from him sons who sit upon his throne for ever.

ORDER 28

[i] In the Syriac text, this is (possibly) 'Tradition 26'; it reads: *The Apostles appointed again that no one presume to do anything by the power of the priesthood, which is impious and unlawful, but only what is just, and free from the fault of partiality.*

፳፱፡ ትእዛዝ።

ካህናት።

ወኢይትሐበሉ፡ ካህናት፡ ወሚዩማን፡ እምግብር፡ ዘተአዘዙ፡ ወኢይትዐደዉ፡ ትእዛዘ፡ እምዘ፡ አብሕዎሙ፡ ከመ፡ ይአዝዙ፡ ወይገሥጹ። ወሚምዎሙ፡ በዘ፡ ይደሉ፡ ወይረትዕ፡ ወአኮ፡ በዘ፡ ይረክብ፡ ኀጢአተ፡ ወቅሥተ፡ ወይከውን፡ በላዕሌሁ፡ ጋእዘ።

ORDER 29

PRIESTS

[i] Let not priests and the appointed presume beyond the work in which they were commanded, and let them not overstep the command beyond that for which they were given authority, that they should command and reprove. And they appointed them in what is fitting and right, and not in what finds sin and reproach, and becomes arrogance on him.

[i] The Syriac text lacks this Order.

፴፡ ትእዛዝ።

በእንተ፡ ቍርባን።

ወያዕርጉ፡ ኅብስተ፡ ዘይትገበር፡ ለቍርባን፡ ዲበ፡ ምሥዋዕ፡ በዕለተ፡ ተገብረ፡ ወኢያስተዳኅርዎ፡ ለጌሠም፡ ወይሜጥዉ፡ በዕለቱ፡ ወኢያትርፉ፡ ለካልእ፡ ዕለት፡ እስመ፡ ኢይደሉ።

ወከመዝ፡ አዘዝናክሙ፡ ከመ፡ ትግበሩ፡ በከመ፡ አርአየክሙ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ እምድኅሬነ።

ORDER 30

CONCERNING THE OBLATION

[i] Let them bring up the bread that is made for the oblation on the altar on the day it was made, and let them not put it off until the morrow; and let them distribute it on its own day, and let them not leave it over for another day; for, it is not fitting.

And thus we have commanded you, that you do as God showed you after us.[ii]

ORDER 30

[i] In the Syriac text, this is 'Tradition 27' (the last); it reads: *The Apostles appointed again that the bread of the oblation go up to the altar on the day on which it is baked, and not after some days have passed, which is not lawful.*

[ii] The Syriac text has a longer colophon: *Here end the canons established by the Holy Apostles for the ordering of the Holy Church. Here ends the first Synod of the Apostles, and likewise the second Synod.*

CONCLUSION

ወዘንተ፡ ሠርዑ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ እንዘ፡ ጉቡኣን፡ እሙንቱ፡ ውስተ፡ ጽርሕ፡ በኢየሩሳሌም፡ ለእለ፡ ሰምዕዎሙ፡ ወተለውዎሙ፡ ወአምኑ፡ በእግዚአብሔር፡ በእደዊሆሙ፡ እምአይሁድ፡ ወእምኵሉ፡ አሕዛብ፡ ወሠርዕዎ፡ ለኵሉ፡ ዓለም፡ እስመ፡ መንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ ዘወረደ፡ ላዕሌሆሙ፡ በመልዕልተ፡ ጽዮን፡ በበዓለ፡ ኀምሳ፡ ኮኖሙ፡ ጥበበ፡ ወአለበዎሙ፡ ኵሎ፡ ዘይትፈቀድ፡ በከመ፡ አሰፈዎሙ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ በኵሉ፡ ግብሮሙ።

[i] And this the Apostles ordained while they were gathered together in the upper room in Jerusalem, for those who heard them and followed them and believed in God by their hands, from among the Jews and from all the nations; and they ordained it for all the world, because the Holy Spirit, which came down on them in the upper part of Zion at the feast of the fifty, became wisdom for them and made them understand, as our Lord Christ promised them in all their deeds. [ii]

ወአልቦሙ፡ ጻማ፡ በእንቲአሁ፡ እስመ፡ ረድኤተ፡ ቦሙ፡ በዘ፡ ተውህበ፡ ሥልጣነ፡ ወለበዉ፡ አእምሮ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወገብርዎ፡ እስመ፡ ይፈርሁ፡ ላዕለ፡ እለ፡ ተለውዎሙ፡ ወአምኑ፡ በእደዊሆሙ፡ እምተኵላት፡ መደልዋን፡ ከመ፡ ኢይምጽኡ፡ ወኢይምሥጥዎሙ፡ እምድኅሬሆሙ፡ እስመቦ፡ ሰብአ፡ እለ፡ ይትሜሰልዎሙ፡ ለሐዋርያት፡ ወይመጽኡ፡ በአርአያ፡ አባግዕ፡ ወእሙንቱሰ፡ ተኵላት፡ መሠጥ፡ ወቀዲሙ፡ ነገሮሙ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ዘንተ።

And they had no toil over it, because they had help in that authority was given to them, and they understood the knowledge of God and did it; for they feared on behalf of those who followed them and believed by their hands, because of deceiving wolves, lest they come and tear them away from behind them; for there are men who liken themselves to the Apostles and come in the likeness of sheep, but they are not. And beforehand our Lord had told them this.

ወጳውሎስኒ፡ ላእከ፡ ጽድቅ፡ ወስልዋኖስ፡ ረድኡ፡ አመ፡ ፆዱ፡ ምድረ፡ ሶርያ፡ ወባዕደኒ፡ አዘዝዎሙ፡ ለእለ፡ አምኑ፡ በእደዊሆሙ፡ ወበእደ፡ ኵሎሙ፡ ሐዋርያት። ወዓዲሆሙ፡ ኢተጋብኡ፡ ወገብሩ፡ ዘንተ፡ ትእዛዘ፡ እንዘ፡ ያነብቡ፡ ፍካሬ፡ መጻሕፍት፡ ቅዱሳት።

And Paul also, the messenger of truth, and Silvanus[iii] his disciple, when they went about the land of Syria and elsewhere, commanded those who believed by their hands and by the hand of all the Apostles. And they did this commandment while they recited the interpretation of the holy books.

CONCLUSION

[i] The Syriac text lacks this paragraph.

[ii] Lumpkin lacks '*as our Lord Christ promised them in all their deeds*'.

[iii] In place of '*Silvanus*', the Syriac text has '*Timothy*'.

ወከሠቱ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ዘቦቱ፡ በቍዔት፡ ለነፍሶሙ፡ ወገብሩ፡ ሕገ፡ ወሥርዐተ፡ ለቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ቅድስት፡ ወውእቱኒ፡ በትሕትና፡ ወየውሀት፡ ወአውፅኡ፡ ኀቡኣተ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ወአርአዩ፡ ተአምረ፡ ዘከመ፡ ገብረ፡ እግዚኦሙ፡ ወከማሁ፡ ኮነ፡ በእደዊሆሙ።

And they disclosed to men that which has profit for their souls, and they made law and ordinance for the holy Church, and that in humility and gentleness; and they brought out hidden things for men and showed a sign such as their Lord had done, and so it came about by their hands.

ወይመጽኡ፡ ኀቤሆሙ፡ ብዙኀ፡ ሰብእ፡ በበዕለቱ፡ ወየአምኑ፡ በክርስቶስ፡ በእደዊሆሙ። ወይመጽኡ፡ ኀቤሆሙ፡ እምርሑቅ፡ ብሔር፡ ወይሰምዑ፡ ቃሎሙ፡ ወይትቄከፉ፡ ትእዛዞሙ፡ ወትምህርቶሙ፡ ጥዩቀ፡ በአማን፡ ወኒቆዲሞስ፡ ወገማልኤል፡ ሊቃነ፡ ካህናት፡ ወማኅበረ፡ አይሁድ፡ ይመጽኡ፡ በኀቡእ፡ ወይትቄከፉ፡ ትምህርቶሙ፡ ወትእዛዞሙ፡ ርኢዮሙ፡ ዘያወፅኡ፡ ኀቡኣተ።

And many people came to them day by day and believed in Christ by their hands. And they came to them from a far country and heard their word and received their commandment and their teaching surely, in truth. And Nicodemus and Gamaliel, chiefs of the priests and of the congregation of the Jews, used to come in secret and receive their teaching and their commandment, having seen that they brought out hidden things.

ወአንቆ፡ ወአሌዊ፡ ወቀዳይ፡ ወኔሪ፡ ወሐና፡ ወቀያፋ፡ ወአስክንድሮስ፡ ካህናተ፡ አይሁድ፡ ይመጽኡ፡ በሌሊት፡ ወይአምኑ፡ ወይገንዩ፡ ከመ፡ ውእቱ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ዘአሐሰውናሁ፡ ውእቱ፡ መሲሐ፡ ጽድቅ፡ ዘተነበዩ፡ ላዕሌሁ፡ ነቢያት፡ ውእቱ፡ ወልደ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በአማን፡ ወኢያግሀዱ፡ እምፍርሀተ፡ አይሁድ።

And Anqo and Levi and Qaday and Neri and Ḥanna and Caiaphas and Alexander, priests of the Jews, used to come by night and believe and confess that he is the Christ whom we called a liar, he is the Messiah of truth of whom the prophets prophesied, he is the Son of God in truth; and they did not make it open, out of fear of the Jews.

ወተወክፍዎሙ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ወተፈሥሑ፡ ቦሙ፡ ወይቤልዎሙ፡ ኢይደልወክሙ፡ ትግበሩ፡ ከመዝ፡ ወኢትኀፈሩ፡ እምሰብእ፡ ወኢትፍርህዎሙ። ወታኀልቁ፡ ሕይወተክሙ፡ በጌጋይ፡ ወበከንቱ። ወይደልወክሙሰ፡ ትፍርህዎ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ዘአልቦ፡ ዘይትኀብአ፡ ወኢትሙቱ፡ በማእከል፡ ወይትኀሠሡክሙ፡ ምስለ፡ አበዊክሙ፡ በደመ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ዘደፈሩ፡ አበዊክሙ፡ ወባሕቱ፡ ይደልወክሙ፡ ለእመ፡ አመንክሙ፡

And the Apostles received them and rejoiced in them, and said to them, “It is not fitting for you to do thus; and do not be ashamed before men, nor fear them.” And do not destroy your life in transgression and in vain. But it is fitting for you to fear God, from whom nothing is hidden; and do not die in the midst, and you will be sought out together with your fathers for the blood of our Lord Christ which your fathers presumed upon. But it is fitting for you, if you

በክርስቶስ፡ ከመ፡ ታጥብዑ፡ ገሀደ፡ ወትእመኑ፡ በሀይማኖት፡ እንተ፡ ዜነዉ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ወትትወከፉ፡ ኵሎ፡ ዘንጼውዕ፡ ሰብአ፡ ኀቤሁ።

have believed in Christ, to be bold openly, and to believe in the faith that the Apostles proclaimed, and to receive every man whom we call to him.

ወሰሚያመ፡ ቃሎሙ፡ ካህናተ፡ አይሁድ፡ ከልሑ፡ በዐቢይ፡ ቃል፡ በማእከለ፡ ኵሎሙ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ወይቤሉ፡ በአማን፡ ንሕነ፡ ነአምን፡ በክርስቶስ፡ ዘሰቀሉ፡ አይሁድ፡ ወተቀብረ፡ ወተንሥአ፡ በሣልስት፡ ዕለት፡ ወንሕነ፡ ንአምን፡ ከመ፡ ውእቱ፡ አምላክ፡ ቀዳማዊ፡ ዘእምትካት፡ ወይትቤቀሎሙ፡ ለእለ፡ ሰቀልዎ። ወንሕነሰ፡ ውፁኣን፡ እምኔሆሙ።

And, when the priests of the Jews had heard their word, they cried out with a great voice in the midst of all the Apostles and said, “Truly we believe in Christ whom the Jews crucified, and he was buried and rose on the third day; and we believe that he is the first God who is from of old, and he will take vengeance on those who crucified him. And as for us, we are gone out from among them.”

ወከሠቱ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ኵሎ፡ ኀቡኣተ፡ ወአምኑ፡ ገሀደ፡ ወኢተፈልጡ፡ እምሐዋርያት፡ እስመ፡ ያሌብውዎሙ፡ ኵሎ፡ ዘመሀሩ፡ ለሰብእ፡ እምሐዲስ፡ ሕግ፡ ዘውእቱ፡ ሥርዐት፡ ኀሩይ፡ ዘወፅአ፡ እምጽዮን፡ በከመ፡ ይቤ፡ ጽሑፍ። ወይሰምዑ፡ ትምህርተ፡ ወይገብርዎ፡ ቅድመ፡ ኵሉ፡ ሰብእ፡ ወለእመ፡ ረከቦሙ፡ ምንዳቤ፡ ለሐዋርያት፡ ይረድእዎሙ፡ ወይትዔገሡ፡ መቅሠፍተ፡ ወመዋቅሕተ፡ ወኵሎ፡ ኀሳረ፡ በእንተ፡ አሚን፡ በክርስቶስ፡ ወይትፈሥሑ፡ በኵሉ፡ ዘረከቦሙ፡ ወያበዝኑ፡ ሐዊረ፡ ኀበ፡ አሚን፡ በእግዚእነ፡ ክርስቶስ።

And they disclosed to men all the hidden things, and believed openly, and were not separated from the Apostles, because they made them understand all that they taught to men out of the new law, which is the chosen ordinance that went out from Zion, according as the scripture said.[iv] And they heard teaching and did it before all men; and if tribulation found the Apostles, they helped them and endured scourging and bonds and every disgrace for the sake of faith in Christ, and they rejoiced in all that found them, and they increased in going toward faith in our Lord Christ.

ወእምድኅረ፡ ወፅኡ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ውስተ፡ ዓለም፡ ኮኑ፡ ሊቃውንተ፡ ለቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ቅድስት፡ ወይኤዝዙ፡ ወይሜህሩ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ኵሎ፡ ዘነሥኡ፡ እምሐዋርያት።

And after the Apostles had gone out into the world, there were elders for the holy Church, and they commanded and taught men all that they had received from the Apostles.

ወአዘዙ፡ እምቅድመ፡ ሞቶሙ፡ ለእለ፡ እምድኅሬሆሙ፡ አርድእቶሙ፡ ወዜነወ፡ አስቅጢ፡ ጳውሎስ፡ ወጸሐፈ፡

And they gave command, before their death, to those who were after them, their disciples. And Paul made it

[iv] It is not clear which passage from Scripture is being referenced here.

ያዕቆብ፡ በኢየሩሰሌም፡ ወስምዖን፡ ጴጥሮስ፡ በሀገረ፡ ሮሜ፡ ወዮሐንስ፡ በኤፌሶን፡ ወማርቆስ፡ በአልስክንድርያ፡ ወእንድርያስ፡ በአፍርጋ፡ ወሉቃስ፡ በመቄዶንያ፡ ወይሁዳ፡ ወቶማስ፡ እምድረ፡ ህንደኬ፡ ጎበ፡ ሊቃውንት፡ ወመሀይምናን፡ ውስተ፡ ኵሎ፡ ዓለም፡ ከመ፡ ይትወከፉ፡ መጻሕፍቲሁ፡ ወመልእክቶ፡ ወያንብብዎ፡ ውስተ፡ ኵሉ፡ አብያተ፡ ክርስቲያናት፡ ዘእግዚአብሔር፡ በከመ፡ ይትነበብ፡ ነገረ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ዘጸሐፈ፡ ሉቃስ፡ ከመ፡ ያእምሩ፡ እስመ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ወነቢያት፡ ወመጻሕፍት፡ ዘቀዳሚ፡ ወዘሐዲስ፡ የኀብሩ፡ በበይናቲሆሙ።

ወጸውዑ፡ ጎበ፡ አሐዱ፡ ጽድቅ፡ ወአሐዱ፡ ቃል፡ ኵሎሙ፡ አሐዱ፡ መንፈስ፡ ዘውእቱ፡ መንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ እምአሐዱ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ዘሎቱ፡ ንሰግድ፡ ኵልነ።

ወተፈነዉ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ወሰበኩ፡ ቦቱ፡ ወጸውዑ፡ ጎቤሁ፡ ኵሎ፡ በሓውርተ፡ ዘርሑቅ፡ እምኔሆሙ። ወኵሎ፡ ዘነሥኡ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ በጎበ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ወመሀሩ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ወተወክፍዎሙ፡ ወአምኑ፡ ቦቱ፡ በኵሉ፡ አህጉር፡ ወብሔር፡ ወእስከ፡ አጽናፈ፡ ኵሉ፡ ዓለም፡ እንዘ፡ ይረድኦሙ፡ ጎይሉ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ወጽንዑ፡ ወኢሐሰወ፡ ቃሎ፡ ዘይቤ፡ አነ፡ እሄሉ፡ ምስሌክሙ፡ እስከ፡ ጎልቀተ፡ ዓለም፡ ወምስለ፡ ዝንቱ፡ ይጽህቁ፡ ተጋድሎ፡ ምስለ፡ አይሁድ፡ በመጻሕፍተ፡ ነቢያት፡ ወይትጋደሉ፡ ምስለ፡ መሰግላን፡ በተኣምር፡ ግሩም፡ ዘይገብሩ፡ በስመ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ክርስቶስ።

ወኵሉ፡ አሕዛብ፡ እለ፡ ባዕዳን፡ አህጉር፡ ተወክፉ፡ ጎበ፡ ተጸውዑ፡ ውስተ፡ አሚን፡ በክርስቶስ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ጋእዝ።

known, and James wrote in Jerusalem, and Simon Peter in the city of Rome, and John in Ephesus, and Mark in Alexandria, and Andrew in Africa[v], and Luke in Macedonia, and Judas and Thomas from the land of India, to the elders and the faithful in all the world, that they should receive his books and his epistle and read it in all the churches of God, according as the account of the Apostles which Luke wrote is read, that they may know that the Apostles and the prophets and the books of the former and of the new agree one with another.

And they called to one truth and one word, all of them one Spirit, which is the Holy Spirit, from one God, to whom we all bow down.

And the Apostles were sent and preached in him and called to him all the regions that were far from them. And all that the Apostles received from our Lord Jesus Christ, and the Apostles taught, they received and believed in him in every city and country and as far as the ends of all the world, while the power of God helped them, and they were strengthened; and his word did not lie, which said, “I am with you until the end of the world.” And along with this they were diligent in contending with the Jews out of the books of the prophets, and they contend with the sorcerers by the awesome sign which they do in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.

And all the peoples who are of other cities received where they were called into faith in Christ. And when tribulation found them

[v] In place of ‘*Africa*’, the Syriac text has ‘*Phrygia*’.

ወሶበ፡ ይረክቦሙ፡ ምንዳቤ፡ በእንቲአሁ፡ ይብሉ፡ ዛቲ፡ ምንዳቤ፡ እንተ፡ ረከበተነ፡ ትተነብል፡ ለነ፡ እስመ፡ ንሕነሂ፡ አስተቈጣዕናሁ፡ ለዘ፡ ፈጠረነ።

ወቦ፡ እምኀቤሆሙ፡ ዘሰቀልዎ፡ ወቦ፡ ዘተቀትለ፡ በሰይፍ፡ ተዐጊሦ፡ ወቦ፡ ዘተበርበረ፡ ንዋዮ፡ በትዕግልት፡ ብዙኀ፡ ጊዜ፡ ወቦ፡ ዘርሕቀ፡ እምንዋዩ፡ ወውሉዱ፡ ወቤቱ፡ ወእንዘ፡ ሀለዉ፡ ውስተ፡ ኵነኔ፡ ወይሣቂይዎሙ፡ ወይትዔገሡ፡ በሥምረቶሙ፡ እስከ፡ ይመውቱ፡ በእንተ፡ አሚን፡ በክርስቶስ።

ወይበዝኁ፡ ወይትወሰኩ፡ ወኢሐጸጸ፡ ስብከቶሙ፡ ወጸውዖቶሙ፡ እስከ፡ ስፍሐ፡ ውስተ፡ አርባዕቱ፡ መአዝነ፡ ዓለም።

ወኢሠርዑ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ዘንተ፡ ኵሎ፡ አመ፡ ወጠኑ፡ ይዜንዉ፡ ወይጸውዑ፡ ውስተ፡ አሚን፡ አላ፡ ጸሀቁ፡ ከመ፡ ይትወከፉ፡ ኵሎ፡ እምጌጋይ፡ ወዕልወት፡ ወአምልኮ፡ ጣዖት፡ ውስተ፡ ርትዕ፡ ወአሚን፡ ወይኤዝዝዎሙ፡ እምበሊዐ፡ ዝቡሕ፡ ለአማልክት፡ ወማውታ፡ ወደም፡ ወዘበፅዑ፡ ለአምላክ፡ ባዕድ።

ወአመ፡ በዝኁ፡ እለ፡ የአምኑ፡ በክርስቶስ፡ ወኮኑ፡ እምኔሆሙ፡ ሰባኪያነ፡ ወዜናዊያነ፡ ወተፈቅደ፡ ይግበሩ፡ ትእዛዘ፡ ወሥርዐተ፡ ለአርትዖ፡ ሕግ፡ ወተፍጻሜተ፡ ግብር፡ ወወሀብዎሙ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ ሶቤሃ፡ ዘንተ፡ ቀኖና፡ ዘይሰመይ፡ በነገረ፡ ጽርእ፡ በጥልሳት፡ በዘጎብሩ፡ ቦቱ፡ ሐዋርያቲሁ፡ ለክርስቶስ፡ ኄራን፡ ወጻድቃን፡ ወንጹሓን፡ መራሕያን፡ ወአዘዙ፡ ባቲ፡ ከመ፡ ይግበርዋ። ወይደልዎ፡ ለዘ፡ ተዐደዋ፡ ኵነኔ፡ ወንሕነሂ፡ ንተሉ፡ አሰረ፡ ዚአሆሙ።

for his sake, they say, “This tribulation which has found us makes intercession for us, because we too provoked to anger him who created us.”

And there was of them one whom they crucified, and one who was killed by the sword, enduring, and one whose goods were taken by violence many times, and one who was parted from his goods, his children, and his house; and, while they were under judgement and they tormented them, they endured by their own will until they died for the sake of faith in Christ.

And they multiplied and were increased, and their preaching and their calling did not diminish, until it spread into the four corners of the world.

And the Apostles did not ordain all this when they began to proclaim and call into the faith, but they were diligent that they might receive all men out of sin, apostasy, and idolatry, into uprightness and faith; and they commanded them concerning eating what is slaughtered to the gods, and what is strangled, and of blood, and what has been vowed to another god.

And, when those who believe in Christ multiplied, and there were among them preachers and heralds, and it was required that they should make statute and ordinance to recitify the law and fulfill the work, then the Apostles gave them this canon, called in the Greek tongue Batlesat, in which the Apostles of Christ, good, righteous, and pure leaders, agreed; and they commanded that they should do it. And judgement is due to him who transgresses it. And we too follow their footsteps.